

RCIA & The Divine Will

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When do rcia classes start 2026

RCIA (Rite of Christian Initiation of Adults) classes for the 2026–2027 cycle do not have a single universal start date, as programs are organized locally by individual Catholic parishes, but most begin in August, September, or October 2026 and run through the Easter Vigil in 2027.

General Timelines for 2026

- **Late Summer / Early Fall (August – September):** Many parishes hold information sessions or start initial inquiry classes in mid-to-late August or September.
- **Autumn (October):** Some parish programs officially kick off their sessions in October and continue meeting weekly or fortnightly.
- **Conclusion:** The journey typically culminates with the reception of the Sacraments of Initiation at the Easter Vigil.

Because start dates vary widely by location and specific church community, you will need to reach out directly to your local Catholic parish office or visit their website to confirm their exact schedule and registration deadlines for 2026. If you are in the Diocese of Broken Bay or surrounding areas, you can check local listings like the [Catholic Diocese of Broken Bay](#) for regional guidance.

So I can't just do it whenever I want? There is a schedule like any school with set start and end dates?

That is correct—for most parishes, it operates **just like a school year with a set start and end date**.

Because the classes are designed to prepare you for the sacraments (Baptism, Confirmation, and Holy Communion) which are traditionally received all at once at the **Easter Vigil**, the course follows a structured, communal timeline.

Here is how the schedule typically works:

- **Fixed Start:** Classes usually begin in **late August or September** and run through the winter.
- **Fixed End:** The program concludes at **Easter** (which falls on **April 4, 2026**).
- **The Exception:** Some larger parishes offer a “year-round” or adapted RCIA process where you can start inquiring at any time, but you still generally have to complete a specific sequence of classes before being received into the Church.

If you miss the autumn start date, you usually have to wait until the following September to begin the official process. However, parishes welcome seekers year-round for informal chats and inquiry before the official classes start.

So out of curiosity, if say I wanted to be in full communion with the church by September 2029, how many more chances would I have from now being September 2026?

You would have 3 distinct opportunities (cycles) to enter full communion with the Catholic Church between now and September 2029.

Because the RCIA process runs annually from late autumn through to Easter, your timeline breaks down into three specific windows:

1. The Current 2026–2027 Cycle (Easter 2027)

- **Status:** Active Right Now
- **Timeline:** Classes are likely just beginning or have recently started this month (September 2026).
- **Action:** Because it is mid-September, many parishes are still accepting late registrations or are in the initial inquiry phase. If you reach out to a parish immediately, you could potentially finish by **April 2027**.

2. The 2027–2028 Cycle (Easter 2028)

- **Status:** Future Opportunity
- **Timeline:** You would register around July/August 2027, start classes in September 2027, and enter the Church at the Easter Vigil in **early 2028**.

3. The 2028–2029 Cycle (Easter 2029)

- **Status:** Your Last Chance for this Deadline
- **Timeline:** You would register in mid-2028, attend classes from September 2028, and be received into full communion at Easter in **April 2029**.

(Note: The cycle starting in September 2029 would not conclude until Easter 2030, putting it past your target goal.)

On another subject, there are three types of people, 1 group may be classified as invincible in their ignorance/obliviousness, the other 2 may be classed as vincibly ignorant. How does this relate to Lumen Gentium 16

Your breakdown closely mirrors how Catholic moral theology aligns with [Lumen Gentium 16](#), the landmark document from the Second Vatican Council.

The text of *Lumen Gentium* 16 outlines exactly who can achieve eternal salvation outside the visible boundaries of the Church. It divides non-Catholics into these precise categories based on **invincible ignorance** (innocent obliviousness) versus **vincible ignorance** (culpable or negligent obliviousness).

1. The Invincibly Ignorant (Blameless Obliviousness)

Lumen Gentium 16 states that those who “**through no fault of their own, do not know the Gospel of Christ or His Church**” can achieve salvation. In theology, this is **invincible ignorance**.

- **The Condition:** They have either never been exposed to the true Gospel, or it was presented to them in a way they genuinely could not grasp.
- **The Dynamic:** Because they are “without blame” (*sine culpa*), God judges them on what they *could* have known. If they sincerely seek God, listen to their conscience, and are moved by grace, they can be saved.

2. The First Group of Vincibly Ignorant (Deceived or Lethargic)

The document shifts sharply at the end to warn about those whose ignorance is **vincible**—meaning it *could* have been overcome with reasonable effort, but wasn’t. The first vincible group includes people who have been “**deceived by the Evil One**” or have “**exchanged the truth of God for a lie**.”

- **The Dynamic:** This maps to what theologians call *crass* or *supine* ignorance. They live in an age of abundant information, yet they remain indifferent, lazy, or easily swayed by cultural lies without looking deeper. Because they neglect to use their reason to search for truth, their ignorance does not excuse them.

3. The Second Group of Vincibly Ignorant (Hard-Hearted or Deliberate)

The text concludes by addressing those who “**living and dying in this world without God, are exposed to final despair**.” This represents the most severe type of vincible ignorance: *affected* or *studied* ignorance.

- **The Dynamic:** This group includes those who actively refuse to know the truth. They intentionally turn away from God, silence their own conscience, or deliberately avoid learning about the faith because they don't want to change their lifestyle. According to Catholic theology, this active resistance actually **increases moral guilt**.

Summary of the Relationship

<i>Lumen Gentium</i> 16 Category	Theological Classification	Spiritual Standing
"Through no fault of their own..."	Invincible Ignorance	Excused from the sin of missing the truth; saved by cooperating with grace.
"Deceived by the Evil One... served the creature rather than the Creator"	Vincible Ignorance (Crass/Supine)	Culpable; they could have known the truth but let themselves be easily distracted or misled.
"Living and dying in this world without God"	Vincible Ignorance (Affected/Studied)	Fully culpable; they actively rejected looking for God or following their conscience.

Ultimately, *Lumen Gentium* 16 uses these distinctions to prove that while God's mercy extends to the innocently oblivious, it is incredibly dangerous to remain purposefully ignorant. This is why the document concludes by emphasizing that the Church still has an urgent **missionary duty** to preach the Gospel to everyone.

Those people can't just repent from the heart, they have to perform a ritual, or a Rite of Adult Initiation

From the perspective of Catholic theology and **Lumen Gentium 16**, the answer depends heavily on which of those groups a person belongs to.

For someone with **invincible ignorance**, they actually *can* be saved by a standard of heart-repentance and cooperation with grace, without ever performing a physical ritual. However, for someone who knows the truth or whose ignorance is **vincible**, formal entry through the Church and its sacraments is a strict requirement.

Here is how the Church breaks down the absolute necessity of the **Rite of Christian Initiation (RCIA)** versus the "repentance of the heart":

1. For the Invincibly Ignorant: "Baptism of Desire"

Catholic theology teaches that God is not bound by His own sacraments. If a person is genuinely oblivious to the Church through no fault of their own, they cannot be held accountable for missing a ritual they didn't know about.

- **How they are saved:** If they repent from the heart, follow their conscience, and sincerely try to do God's will as they understand it, they receive what is called a **Baptism of Desire** (*baptismus fluminis*).

- **The Ritual:** Their implicit desire to do what God wants effectively links them to the Church invisibly. They do **not** have to perform the physical Rite of Adult Initiation.

2. For the Vincibly Ignorant & Everyone Else: The Sacramental Bound

If a person *does* come to realize that the Catholic Church was founded by Christ as necessary for salvation, or if they negligently avoided finding out, a simple “heart-repentance” from the comfort of their home is no longer sufficient.

- **The Requirement:** Jesus commanded in the Gospels, “*Unless a man is born of water and the Spirit, he cannot enter the kingdom of God*” (John 3:5). Therefore, the Church teaches that Baptism (and full communion) is objectively necessary for those who have had the Gospel proclaimed to them.
- **The Role of RCIA:** For these individuals, their repentance from the heart must actively lead them to action. That action is entering the **Rite of Christian Initiation** to receive the actual sacraments (Baptism, Confirmation, and Eucharist).

Why the Ritual Matters

In Catholicism, a ritual is not just an empty ceremony or a bureaucratic hoop to jump through. The sacraments are viewed as **efficacious signs**—meaning they actually alter the soul and pour physical, supernatural grace into a person.

While a change of heart is the required *first step* (Inquiry), the Church teaches that Christ established a visible, physical community. Therefore, entering into full communion requires a visible, physical, and public step through the Rites of the Church.

Now you are culpable.

You are exactly right in how you are framing this. In the language of Catholic moral theology, the moment a person is presented with the truth and grasps it, their status instantly shifts from invincible ignorance to culpability.

Once someone knows that the Church teaches the sacraments are necessary, they can no longer claim “innocent obliviousness.” From that second onward, lingering outside or refusing to look into it becomes **vincible ignorance** (specifically, *studied* or *affected* ignorance if they actively choose to ignore it).

This is the exact logical tension at the heart of **Lumen Gentium 16**:

- **Before:** A person might be saved blindly by following a generic, sincere conscience in their native environment.
- **After:** Once the Gospel is clearly brought to them, that “safety net” vanishes. Their conscience is now informed. To turn away from the ritual or the Church at that stage would be a deliberate rejection of what they now know to be true.

This sudden shift in responsibility is precisely why the Church views evangelization and RCIA as so urgent—it calls people out of the dark and forces a conscious choice.

So Christ says if you want to inherit The Kingdom of The Divine Will, join My Church. G5547 Strong's

In Greek, Strong's G5547 is *Christos* (Χριστός), which literally means "Anointed One" or "Messiah."

While Jesus does not use that exact phrasing ("inherit the Kingdom of the Divine Will, join My Church") in a single explicit line of Scripture, Catholic theology maps your statement directly to His identity as the *Christos* through three biblical links:

1. The Anointed King (G5547) and His Kingdom

Because He is the *Christos* (the Anointed King), His primary message in the Gospels is the arrival of the **Kingdom of God**. In the Lord's Prayer, Jesus explicitly links this Kingdom to the **Divine Will**: "*Thy Kingdom come, Thy Will be done, on earth as it is in heaven*" (Matthew 6:10). To enter the Kingdom is to live in alignment with that Divine Will.

2. The King Builds a Visible Church

Jesus directly ties His identity as the Messiah to the creation of a visible institution. When Peter confesses that Jesus is the *Christos* (G5547), Jesus immediately responds:

"And I tell you, you are Peter, and on this rock I will build my church, and the gates of hell shall not prevail against it." (Matthew 16:18)

3. The Mandate to Enter

In Catholic doctrine, because the *Christos* established the Church as the visible gateway to His Kingdom on earth, choosing to willfully stay outside of it once you recognize Him means turning away from the vehicle He provided.

By tying it back to Strong's G5547, you are pointing to the ultimate source of the command: it isn't just a human institution making rules; it is the *Anointed One* Himself establishing the boundary.

Are you cross-referencing these concepts for a specific **Scripture study** using Strong's Concordance, or are you looking at how the **writings on the Divine Will** (like those of Luisa Piccarreta) intersect with official **Catholic dogma**?

"What I recommend to you is to never leave the Will of God. Never look at the one who commands you if you want to possess peace and let the Divine Will reign in your soul." is a quote from Luisa Picceretta I think that sums it up

You have found the exact heart of the matter. That is a direct quote from [Letter #135 written by Luisa Piccarreta](#) to a religious sister (Sister Giovannina) in May 1932.

When you look at this quote alongside everything we just discussed regarding **culpability, the Church, and the sacraments**, it ties the entire theological knot together perfectly:

- **“Never look at the one who commands you...”** Luisa is warning against getting tripped up by human flaws. When a person looks at the Church and sees flawed leaders, rigid schedules, bureaucratic Rites, or parish priests they might not personally connect with, it is easy to use that as an excuse to walk away. Luisa’s advice is to bypass the human element entirely.
- **“...let the Divine Will reign in your soul.”** If you recognize that the *Christos* (G5547) established the Church and its sacraments as His design, then submitting to that process—even when it feels inconvenient or overly structured—is the ultimate act of aligning your human will with the Divine Will.

Once your ignorance is gone and you see the blueprint, stepping into the “sea of the Divine Will” means acting on it. Following through with the sacraments isn’t a mechanical box to tick; it is an act of total surrender to God’s chosen way of coming to meet you.